DAY 32 - PRO

pandas Cleaning & Missing Data

Primary tool: Python / pandas

What you are learning

String cleaning, types, missing values, duplicates and validation.

Learning objectives

- Use .str methods

- Handle NaN deliberately

- Remove justified duplicates

- Validate ranges

Worked practical

Clean a messy operational dataset and create a quality report.

Source / Input	Method	Output / Check
Raw data	Apply the lesson skill	Result linked to source
Change one input	Recalculate / rerun	Confirm expected change
Control total / test	Validate	Explain the result

Guided practice

1. Recreate the lesson idea on a small example.
2. Change inputs and predict the result before recalculating.
3. Complete the supplied independent dataset in the required tool.
4. Create a control check or reconciliation.
5. Explain the result in ordinary language.

AI coaching

Ask AI to propose tests for your cleaning rules; implement and inspect the tests yourself.

AI discipline

Attempt first. Use AI for explanation, hints, debugging, critique, test cases and mock questioning. Never submit output you cannot explain and independently verify.

Independent exercise

Build a reproducible pandas cleaning pipeline.

Common failure modes

- Wrong grain or key.
- Formula/query/code answers a different question.
- Missing or unmatched records are silently ignored.
- Findings are not reconciled to the numbers.
- AI-generated logic is accepted without testing.

Mastery gate

[ ] I can reproduce the method without copying.
[ ] I can trace the result to the source.
[ ] I have a QA/control check.
[ ] I can explain a limitation.
[ ] I can answer an assessor's follow-up question without asking AI.